Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Telehealth and Other Virtual Services

Application: Medicare Advantage and Medicaid Products
Policy number: CP2008102
Related policies: N/A

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Overview

Telehealth is a method of delivering healthcare services via *electronic information and telecommunications technologies*. Not all healthcare services delivered via *electronic information and telecommunication technology* are considered *telehealth* services. Examples of other healthcare services delivered via *electronic information and telecommunications technologies* that are not *telehealth* services include interprofessional services and remote monitoring services.

The following policy outlines how Humana plans reimburse *telehealth* and other virtual services.

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Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

In addition to the policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

The following policy applies to only professional services. This policy does not apply for services rendered during the COVID-19 Public Health Emergency (PHE).

Note: Humana allows an originating site fee, reported by *Healthcare Common Procedure Coding System (HCPCS) code Q3014*, to facilities that provide administrative support for a professional's provision of a *telehealth* service if the patient is physically present at that facility. The originating site fee is not a *telehealth* service. The professional who provided the *telehealth* service is not eligible to receive reimbursement for the originating site fee in addition to the *telehealth* service provided.

Original Medicare Telehealth Services

Humana requires a provider to submit a charge for an *Original Medicare telehealth service* according to the applicable Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) guidance for the date of service. Humana Medicare Advantage (MA) plans allow *Original Medicare telehealth services* consistent with the applicable CMS guidance for the date of service. Humana MA plans deny charges for *Original Medicare telehealth services* that do not satisfy the applicable CMS guidance, including billing guidance regarding the appropriate place of service (POS) code or modifier, for the date of service.

For further information on the service codes that may be reported as an *Original Medicare telehealth service*, see CMS's List of Telehealth Services.

Note: Humana MA plans have been applying the Congressionally-authorized, coverage-related waivers to *Original Medicare telehealth services*. These waivers expire December 31, 2027. Following CMS guidelines, Humana will apply the applicable limitations to a claim for a telehealth service beginning January 1, 2028, unless the service qualifies for coverage under the *additional telehealth services* benefit. For further information on the limitations that apply to *Original Medicare telehealth service* beginning January 1, 2028, see the CMS guidance available in the References section of this policy.

Additional Telehealth Services

For dates of service beginning January 1, 2020, Humana MA plans also allow certain *additional telehealth services* that are not *Original Medicare telehealth services*. *Additional telehealth services* must meet the following criteria:

- The service must be one of those covered under the *additional telehealth service* benefit in the member's applicable Evidence of Coverage.
- The service must be provided by a physician or other qualified healthcare practitioner that has satisfied Humana's *telehealth* credentialing and recredentialing standards and has a valid and effective contract with Humana.
- The service must be provided by a physician or other qualified healthcare practitioner that satisfies the following requirements:
  - Meets all applicable licensure, certification and registration requirements, including Drug Enforcement Administration (DEA) registration, if applicable, in the state(s) in which they practice and the state in which the patient is located at the time of the encounter;
  - Is operating within the scope of their license; and
  - Meets professional practice standards in the state(s) in which they practice and the state in which the patient is located at the time of the encounter.
- The service must be provided using real-time interactive audio technology, and Humana encourages providers to simultaneously use real-time interactive video technology, when appropriate. For a charge for a particular service to be reimbursed, it must be possible to provide all the necessary components of the code with the real-time interactive technology used.
- The physician or other qualified healthcare practitioner must verify the member's identity before providing the service.
- The Humana member must provide verbal or written consent to receive the service, in accordance with state law.
- The Humana member must be present for the full duration of the service.

Services not meeting the criteria outlined above will not be allowed by Humana as *additional telehealth services*.

Unless prohibited by applicable federal statute or regulation, Humana plans allow *additional telehealth services* if it is medically appropriate to furnish the service via telecommunications-based technology, the service is coverable by the plan, and all applicable coding requirements are satisfied. For further information on the service codes that may be reported as *additional telehealth services*, see the Medicare Advantage Additional Telehealth Services Benefit Code List section of the policy.

Physicians are responsible for supervising any *additional telehealth services* provided to Humana MA members by nonphysician practitioners within their practices to ensure that such services conform in all respects to the requirements set forth herein.

Billing
Place of Service Code
Humana requires a provider report the POS code for an *additional telehealth service* as outlined below.

For dates of service beginning January 1, 2024, a provider must report one of the following, as appropriate:

- *POS code 02*
- *POS code 10*
- The applicable hospital POS code, if the patient is at home and the physician or other qualified healthcare practitioner is in the hospital, with *modifier 93* or *modifier 95*

For dates of service from May 12, 2023, through December 31, 2023, a provider must report one of the following, as appropriate:

- *POS code 02*
- *POS code 10*
- The POS code that would have been reported had the service been furnished in person with *modifier 93*
- The POS code that would have been reported had the service been furnished in person with *modifier 95*

Note: The POS code billed for a service will determine whether that service is reimbursed with a *facility or nonfacility rate*.

Audio-Only Modifier
Humana requires a provider to identify an audio-only service with *modifier 93*.

Medicare Advantage Additional Telehealth Services Benefit Code List
The attached lists of procedure codes serve as a guide to assist providers in determining which services may be reimbursable under Humana's MA *additional telehealth services* benefit. **Click here*** to view the attached code list for the applicable year.

*This document must be downloaded, saved as a PDF and opened in Adobe Acrobat to display attached files.

Other Virtual Services
Humana MA plans also allow other virtual services that are covered by Original Medicare but are not *Original Medicare telehealth services.* These include, but are not limited to, e-visits, virtual check-ins and remote monitoring.

Humana requires a provider to submit a charge for a virtual service covered by Original Medicare according to the applicable CMS guidance. Humana MA plans allow such services consistent with the applicable CMS guidance. Humana MA plans deny charges for such services that do not satisfy the applicable CMS guidance.

Specific Requirements for Claims Submitted by Federally Qualified Health Centers and Rural Health Clinics

A Federally Qualified Health Center (FQHC) or Rural Health Clinic (RHC) reporting an *Original Medicare telehealth service*, *additional telehealth service*, or other virtual service should follow the applicable CMS guidance for the date of service.

This also includes, but is not limited to, the following guidance for reporting the correct procedure code for the service:

- An *Original Medicare telehealth service* or *additional telehealth service* that is a mental health service should be reported with the applicable HCPCS Level II or Current Procedural Terminology (CPT®) code for the service rendered. For the service to be allowed as an *Original Medicare telehealth service*, it must be on CMS's List of Telehealth Services. For the service to be allowed as an *additional telehealth service*, it must be on the attached list of services that may be reimbursable under Humana's *additional telehealth services* benefit for the applicable year.
- An *Original Medicare telehealth service* or *additional telehealth service* that is not a mental health service should be reported with *HCPCS code G2025*.
- Another virtual service that is covered by Original Medicare but is not an *Original Medicare telehealth service*, as described above, should be reported according to the applicable CMS guidance for the date of service. For dates of service through December 31, 2025, FQHC and RHC providers should report the virtual service with *HCPCS code G0071*. For dates of service beginning January 1, 2026, FQHC and RHC providers should report the virtual service using the same service code as professional providers.

In addition, FQHC and RHC providers should append *modifier 95* when reporting an *Original Medicare telehealth service* or *additional telehealth service*.

Medicaid Payment Policy

In addition to the policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

Humana Medicaid plans allow *telehealth* services consistent with federal law and state Medicaid agency requirements.

Definitions of *Italicized* Terms

- ***Additional telehealth services:*** Telehealth services provided by an MA plan, beginning in plan year 2020, under Section 1852(m) of the Social Security Act and which are treated as a basic benefit rather than a supplemental benefit.
- ***Electronic information and telecommunication technology:*** Technologies and devices which enable secure electronic communications and information exchange and typically involve the application of secure real-time audio/video conferencing or similar services, remote monitoring, or store and forward medical data technology to provide or support healthcare services.
- ***Facility or nonfacility rate***: A facility rate is the rate that would be applicable to services, under the Medicare Physician Fee Schedule (MPFS), when the patient received face-to-face services in a setting defined by the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) as a facility setting. A nonfacility rate is the rate that would be applicable to services, under the MPFS, when the patient received face-to-face services in a setting defined by CMS as a nonfacility setting. A practitioner may have, for a particular procedure code, a nonfacility rate and a facility rate.
- ***HCPCS code G0071:*** Payment for communication technology-based services for 5 minutes or more of a virtual (non-face-to-face) communication between an rural health clinic (RHC) or federally qualified health center (FQHC) practitioner and RHC or FQHC patient, or 5 minutes or more of remote evaluation of recorded video and/or images by an RHC or FQHC practitioner, occurring in lieu of an office visit; RHC or FQHC only.
- ***HCPCS code Q3014:*** Telehealth originating site facility fee.
- ***Modifier 93:*** Synchronous Telemedicine Service Rendered Via Telephone or Other Real-Time Interactive Audio-Only Telecommunications System.
- ***Modifier 95:*** Synchronous Telemedicine Service Rendered Via a Real-Time Interactive Audio and Video Telecommunications System.

- ***Original Medicare telehealth services:*** Telehealth services covered by Original Medicare under Section 1834(m) of the Social Security Act.
- ***Place of service code 02:*** Telehealth Provided Other than in Patient's Home.
- ***Place of service code 10***: Telehealth Provided in Patient's Home.
- ***Telehealth:*** A means to deliver healthcare services to a patient at a different physical location than the health professional using electronic information or telecommunications technologies consistent with applicable state and federal law. Telehealth services include telemedicine services and are also known as virtual visits.

References

- Social Security Administration website. Social Security Act. Title 18. Section 1834 – Special Payment Rules for Particular Items and Services. Paragraph (m) – Payment for Telehealth Services. www.ssa.gov.
- Social Security Administration website. Social Security Act. Title 18. Section 1852 – Benefits and Beneficiary Protections. Paragraph (m) – Provision of Additional Telehealth Benefits. www.ssa.gov.
- U.S. Department of Health and Human Services website. Telehealth Policy Updates. Telehealth.hhs.gov.
- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. Medicare Claims Processing Manual. Chapter 12 – Physicians/Nonphysicians Practitioners. Section 190 – Medicare Payment for Telehealth Services. www.cms.gov.
- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. List of Telehealth Services. www.cms.gov.
- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. Medicare Learning Network. MLN Booklet: Telehealth & Remote Patient Monitoring. www.cms.gov.
- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. Place of Service Code Set: Place of Service Codes for Professional Claims. www.cms.gov.
- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services HCPCS Level II and associated publications and services.
- American Medical Association's CPT and associated publications and services.

General Humana Resources

- Availity – Providers can register for access to information on a variety of topics such as eligibility, benefits, referrals, authorizations, claims and electronic remittances.
- Claims processing edit notifications – Alerts of upcoming claims payment changes are posted on the first Friday of each month.
- Claims resources – Providers can find information on referrals, authorizations, electronic claim submissions and more.
- Making it easier – This page contains an educational series for providers and healthcare professionals.
- Medical and pharmacy coverage policies – Humana publishes determinations of coverage of medical procedures, devices and medications for the treatment of various conditions. There may be variances in coverage among plans.
- Publications – This page can help you find our quarterly newsletter, provider manual and other resources to help you do business with us.

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